

THE NURTURE MOMS

Pregnancy Wellness Starter Guide

Simple, practical guidance for Indian moms — from the first positive test to preparing for birth.

MOVE • NOURISH • PREPARE • CONNECT

“You don't need a perfect pregnancy. You need support, nourishment, movement that feels right, and care you can trust.”

A free resource from The Nurture Moms

Created for education and everyday support. This guide does not replace individualized care from your obstetrician, midwife, dietitian, or other qualified healthcare professional.

1. Your Pregnancy Wellness Foundation

Pregnancy is a time of major physical and emotional change. The basics matter more than perfection: regular antenatal care, a varied diet, appropriate movement, rest, hydration, and timely medical advice.

Your simple daily checklist

- Eat regular, balanced meals rather than trying to “eat for two.”
- Include a protein source in meals and snacks.
- Add vegetables and fruit across the day.
- Choose whole grains or other high-fibre carbohydrate sources regularly.
- Drink fluids regularly; water can be your main drink.
- Take pregnancy supplements exactly as recommended by your healthcare professional.
- Move your body in a way that has been cleared as appropriate for your pregnancy.
- Make time for rest, sleep and emotional support.

Antenatal care matters

WHO guidance includes regular antenatal contacts, nutritional counselling, routine maternal and fetal assessment, and preparation for birth and possible complications. Your schedule should follow the care plan recommended for your pregnancy and local healthcare system.

If your pregnancy is considered high-risk, follow your obstetrician’s individualized advice rather than a generic exercise or nutrition plan.

2. Nourish Your Pregnancy — The Simple Plate

You do not need an expensive “pregnancy diet.” A varied, balanced pattern built from familiar foods can cover many nutritional needs.

Build most meals with these 4 parts

- Protein: dal, beans, chickpeas, rajma, eggs, curd/paneer, fish, chicken or other suitable protein foods.
- Vegetables: leafy greens and a variety of colourful vegetables.
- Carbohydrates: rice, roti, oats, millets, potatoes, whole-grain breads or other staple grains.
- Healthy fats: nuts, seeds, nut/seed pastes, and appropriate cooking oils in sensible amounts.

Easy Indian combinations

- Idli + sambar + vegetable side
- Roti + dal + sabzi + curd
- Rice + rajma/chole + vegetables
- Vegetable upma/poha + curd + fruit
- Khichdi with dal + vegetables + curd
- Egg/vegetable dosa + sambar
- Millet roti + paneer/egg curry + vegetables

Think variety across the week — you do not need to make every single meal perfectly balanced.

3. Nutrients to Pay Attention To

Pregnancy increases the need for several nutrients. Your prenatal supplement should be selected with your healthcare professional, especially if you have anaemia, thyroid disease, diabetes, a vegetarian/vegan diet, or other medical or nutritional needs.

Nutrient	Why it matters	Food examples
Folate / folic acid	Important early in pregnancy for fetal neural tube development.	Leafy greens, beans, lentils, chickpeas, oranges + prescribed folic acid
Iron	Supports increased blood production and helps prevent iron-deficiency anaemia.	Dal, beans, greens, meat, eggs, fortified foods + prescribed supplement if advised
Calcium	Important for bones and teeth and maternal health.	Milk, curd, paneer, calcium-set tofu, some leafy greens
Vitamin D	Supports bone and muscle health and calcium metabolism.	Eggs, oily fish, fortified foods + supplement if advised
Protein	Provides building blocks for maternal tissues and fetal growth.	Dal, beans, eggs, dairy, fish, chicken, meat, tofu
Iodine & B12	Important micronutrients during pregnancy; needs depend on diet and local guidance.	Iodized salt, dairy/eggs; B12-rich animal foods or supplementation when indicated

Important: supplements are not “one size fits all.” Do not add high-dose vitamins or herbal products on your own. Some supplements can be harmful in pregnancy.

4. First Trimester — Gentle Foundations

Early pregnancy can bring nausea, vomiting, tiredness, food aversions and changing appetite. The goal is not to force a perfect menu; focus on tolerable, nourishing foods and hydration.

When nausea is making food difficult

- Try smaller, more frequent meals if large meals feel overwhelming.
- Keep a simple snack available when you wake or when nausea tends to start.
- Choose foods that are easier for you to tolerate — for example, toast, idli, rice, banana, curd or simple dal-based foods.
- Sip fluids regularly. If vomiting is persistent or you cannot keep fluids down, contact your healthcare professional.
- Avoid strong smells or foods that reliably trigger symptoms.

First-trimester essentials

- Start/continue folic acid as advised; routine guidance commonly recommends 400 mcg daily through the first 12 weeks.
- Attend your early antenatal appointment and recommended screening.
- Review all medicines, supplements and herbal products with your healthcare professional.
- Ask about iron, vitamin D and other supplements based on your individual needs.

5. Second & Third Trimester — Build Strength & Prepare

As pregnancy progresses, appetite and energy needs can change. Continue the same foundation of varied foods, with attention to protein, iron, calcium, fluids and fibre.

Simple habits for the middle & later months

- Keep protein foods in regular rotation.
- Include iron-rich foods and follow your prescribed iron plan if one has been given.
- Pair plant-based iron foods with vitamin-C-rich foods such as citrus, guava, tomato or capsicum.
- Include calcium-rich foods regularly.
- Keep fibre-rich foods and fluids in your routine to support comfortable digestion.
- Ask your care team about gestational diabetes screening and any diet changes recommended for you.
- Discuss safe activity and pregnancy yoga with your obstetrician or qualified prenatal instructor.

Birth preparation

Use the later months to discuss birth preferences, hospital planning, breastfeeding, newborn care, emergency contacts and postpartum support. Preparing is about feeling informed — not predicting exactly how birth will happen.

6. Pregnancy Movement & Yoga

For many healthy pregnancies, staying physically active can be beneficial. But exercise recommendations need to be individualized when complications or medical restrictions are present.

Gentle movement ideas
• Comfortable walking, if cleared for you.
• Breathing and relaxation practices.
• Pregnancy-appropriate mobility and gentle stretching.
• Prenatal yoga taught with pregnancy-specific modifications.
• Pelvic-floor awareness and posture work when appropriate.

Pause and check with your healthcare professional if you have been advised to restrict activity, or if you have bleeding, significant pain, leaking fluid, contractions, dizziness/fainting, chest pain, severe breathlessness or other concerning symptoms.

The Nurture Moms — Prenatal Yoga

Our approach is gentle, practical and pregnancy-aware — with options for different stages and comfort levels. For high-risk pregnancies or specific medical concerns, individualized clearance and professional guidance are essential.

[Join a prenatal yoga session →](#)

7. Foods & Supplements: What to Check

Pregnancy food-safety advice varies by country and personal risk. Follow your local medical guidance and food-safety recommendations.

Be extra careful with
• Raw or undercooked eggs, meat, poultry and seafood.
• Unpasteurized milk or foods made from it.
• High-mercury fish; choose lower-mercury options according to local guidance.
• Unwashed produce and foods with uncertain hygiene.
• Alcohol — avoid it during pregnancy.
• Liver and liver products, and supplements containing retinol/vitamin A, unless your healthcare professional specifically advises otherwise.
• Unverified herbal remedies, detox products and high-dose supplements.

Supplements

Folic acid is routinely recommended around conception and early pregnancy. Iron and folic acid supplementation is part of WHO antenatal guidance, while calcium supplementation may be recommended in populations with low dietary calcium intake. Your exact supplement plan should come from your obstetrician or other qualified clinician.

8. A Simple 7-Day Pregnancy Food Framework

Use this as an inspiration list — not a rigid meal plan. Swap foods according to your preferences, culture, allergies, medical needs and appetite.

Day	Breakfast	Main meal idea	Snack / add-on
1	Idli + sambar	Rice + dal + veg + curd	Fruit + nuts
2	Oats + milk/curd + fruit	Roti + chana + sabzi	Roasted chana
3	Poha + vegetables + curd	Khichdi + veg + curd	Fruit + seeds
4	Dosa + sambar	Rice + fish/egg or dal + veg	Curd + fruit
5	Upma + vegetables	Roti + paneer/tofu + sabzi	Nuts + fruit
6	Paratha + curd + veg	Rice + rajma + salad/veg	Homemade snack
7	Egg/veg dosa or idli	Roti + dal + mixed veg + curd	Fruit + nut/seed mix

Easy swaps: dal ↔ beans/chickpeas; rice ↔ roti/millet; curd ↔ another suitable calcium-rich food; egg/fish/chicken ↔ paneer/tofu/dal according to your dietary pattern.

9. When to Reach Out for Support

Pregnancy is not the time to manage everything alone. Speak with your maternity team when you have questions or symptoms that concern you.

Contact your healthcare professional promptly for concerns such as

- Persistent vomiting or difficulty keeping fluids down.
- Bleeding, leaking fluid or painful/regular contractions.
- Severe or persistent abdominal pain.
- Severe headache, vision changes, sudden swelling or other symptoms that concern you.
- Reduced or changed fetal movements later in pregnancy, according to the movement guidance given by your care team.
- Fever or signs of infection.
- Any symptom that feels unusual or worrying to you.

Your emotional wellbeing matters too

Pregnancy can bring anxiety, overwhelm, low mood or loneliness. Tell someone you trust and speak with your healthcare professional if emotional symptoms are persistent, intense, or affecting daily life.

You deserve support, not pressure.

10. Your Nurture Moms Pregnancy Support

You don't have to navigate pregnancy through endless advice online. The Nurture Moms brings together practical support for moms — with pregnancy yoga, maternal & child nutrition guidance, community connection and resources for the journey ahead.

Explore Prenatal Yoga

Explore Nutrition Support

Join The Nurture Moms Community

ABOUT THIS GUIDE

This free guide is designed for general education and everyday support. It is not a substitute for individualized medical advice, diagnosis or treatment. Pregnancy needs can differ significantly, especially with medical conditions, multiple pregnancy, previous complications, dietary restrictions or high-risk pregnancy.

Key sources used for this guide

- World Health Organization (WHO): antenatal care and maternal nutrition guidance. [\[cite\]turn0search36\[turn0search7\]](#)
- NHS: healthy eating and vitamins/supplements in pregnancy. [\[cite\]turn0search1\[turn0search0\]](#)
- CDC: folic acid guidance. [\[cite\]turn0search6\]](#)

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